

THE TOP FIVE

***Pathaan* is already the biggest Hindi film to breach the Rs 400 cr mark in India, almost at par with southern blockbusters dubbed in Hindi**

NATIONAL
(Domestic Net Collection)



Bahubali: The Conclusion*
(Released: Apr. 2017)
₹510 CRORE



Pathaan
(Released: Jan. 2023)
₹476 CRORE



KGF: Chapter 2*
(Released: Apr. 2022)
₹427 CRORE



Dangal
(Released: Dec. 2016)
₹374 CRORE



Tiger Zinda Hai
(Released: Dec. 2017)
₹339 CRORE

**Films dubbed in Hindi*

WORLDWIDE
(Gross Domestic & Overseas)



Dangal
$304 MILLION
(₹2,518 crore)



Bahubali: The Conclusion
$254 MILLION
(₹2,104 crore)



RRR*
$159 MILLION
(₹1,317 crore)



Bajrangi Bhaijaan
$121 MILLION
(₹1,002 crore)



Pathaan*
$114 MILLION
(₹945 crore)

**Not yet released in China*

Source: boxofficeindia.com & boxofficemojo.com; all figures as on Feb. 14, 2023

WHY *PATHAAN* HAS STRUCK A CHORD

The film is a testament to the changing demands of Bollywood and Khan's ability to meet them. At age 57, he has reinvented himself as a mass action hero with eight-pack abs—a quantum leap from the romantic, emotive and bubbly hero that had endeared him to a whole generation of moviegoers in the past. He has dabbled with action before—in the two *Don* films and *Ra.One*—but the effect has never been as thunderous. Khan has consciously wired himself to the changing tastes of the new generation that forms a sizeable section of the audience—one that 'binges' rather than sees and for whom a 'reel' is a short clip on Instagram.



"The last four days have made me forget the last four years"

–SHAH RUKH KHAN
at the only media event for Pathaan, *held in Mumbai on Jan. 30*

He is keen to familiarise himself with their ways and lingo. *Pathaan*'s dialogues are tailored for this generation. Like these words by a scientist in the film: "Science is easy, Farooqui. Love is hard."

An out-and-out commercial potboiler, *Pathaan* doesn't take itself too seriously, but makes sure it treats its audiences' expectations sincerely. At a crisp two hours and 26 minutes, there is never a dull moment in the film, packed as it is with riveting action set pieces in foreign locales that reference many a Hollywood film. Writer Sridhar Raghavan and dialogue writer Abbas Tyrewala throw in some tongue-in-cheek humour, eschew excessive political commentary so as to not offend anyone and